

LAST WEEK, SURROUNDED BY SHOBHA BROOTA'S 'Origin' series of abstract works (mostly oils and pastels), a long-dormant memory of visiting Kolkata's Birla Planetarium resurfaced in my mind without warning. I was very young and the vivid images and animations pertaining to the Big Bang were fascinating and frightening in equal measure. A similar feeling enveloped me while staring at 'Origin 48' (1990, oil-on-canvas, 96.7 x 67.5 inches), part of *Shobha Broota: Painting Infinity*, a career retrospective currently on display at DAG, New Delhi. The painting was created using Broota's signature finger-flicking technique, wherein the paintbrush does not enter the fray at all. Instead, Broota uses her fingers to flick paint directly onto the canvas, creating intricate, pointillist fever dreams like 'Origin 48'—which looks as though a blazing primaeval sun suddenly materialised on a dark planet, saturating every inch of it with unforgiving, white-hot light.

"It's so difficult to come up with good names for your works," quips the 82-year-old Broota. "You want the name to match the sensibility of the work, its emotional core. But there are only so many words in the English language. With the 'Origin' series, I arrived at the name after realising that there was a 'nothingness' inside of me. I was whittling away all the unnecessary parts from my art, everything that was not required, and arriving at the most basic 'dot', the dot of nothingness, of a new '*shuruaat*' [beginning]. And 'Origin' is about the *shuruaat* of everything."

WITH THIS SERIES, BROOTA WANTED TO WHITTLE AWAY THE UNNECESSARY PARTS OF HER ART, ARRIVING AT THE MOST BASIC DOT, OF NOTHINGNESS, OF A NEW '*SHURUAAT*' [BEGINNING]

EXHIBITION ▶

Modernism on Canvas

GALLERIE GANESHA REVISITS ITS ROOTS WITH A SOLO EXHIBITION OF THE LATE MODERNIST **K.S. KULKARNI**

One of Delhi's oldest and most respected art spaces—Gallerie Ganesha—is presenting a solo exhibition of the late modernist K.S. Kulkarni. The show features a curated selection of Kulkarni's works from the 1980s to the mid-1990s, offering a rare glimpse into the evolution of his artistic language.

A pioneering figure in Indian modern art, Kulkarni was not only a celebrated painter but also a revered educator. He co-founded Triveni Kala Sangam—Delhi's iconic cultural hub—and served as its first art director.



FLAT AND FIERY Clockwise from right: Kulkarni's 'Untitled' (15 x 22 inches), 'Flute Player' and 'Untitled' (25 x 22 inches)